

12.1 Themes

“Themes” basically mean how your text is arranged on the slide, what fonts and text sizes are used, what colour combinations and effects are present, and such.

There is a slight difference in terminology: what was called “Design Templates” in PowerPoint 2003 are called Themes in PowerPoint 2007.

From here on, when we say “Themes,” we mean Themes in PowerPoint 2007. For information about PowerPoint 2003’s Design Templates, look at chapter 5.

PowerPoint 2007 offers a built in choice of 20 themes. This might seem limited, but by choosing a base theme and playing around with different colour combinations and fonts, you can create an unlimited variety of designs. (Caution, Achtung, Warning: Do *not* overdo!)

You can also download themes online for free—there is a wide variety to choose from, both from the official Microsoft site as well as from independent sites (www.brainybetty.com, for one).

To download from Office Online, in the Themes gallery, click the More Themes on Microsoft Office Online link.

Some of these themes only work with PowerPoint 2007, while others work with both PowerPoint 2003 and PowerPoint 2007.

You can go ahead and create your own theme using the Slide Master.



Look at all that eye candy!